

LEC14 - Education

If you want to get ahead in life, is postsecondary education a good idea?

- Yes, because there is a relationship between time spent in school, and income earned in the labour market.
 - Furthermore, time spent in school correlates to a family's SES
 - As family SES increases, so does the likelihood of attending University
-

Costs of PostSecondary Education

- Tuition increases (including relative to inflation and other consumer goods)
 - There are variations across the country due to funding and regulation
 - Funding has gone down over time (transfers of tax money to universities), which raises tuition prices
 - Dentistry is the most expensive program (45k/year)
 - International students pay much more tuition since international fees are not regulated
-

Which group is most impacted by the fees of professional programs

- Middle SES since low SES can rely on grants and other eligible loans
-

Educational Attainment and Achievement

- A- is an example of educational achievement
 - High school diploma is an example of educational attainment
 - SES of family is the most important influence on attainment and achievement in education
-

Theoretical Perspectives on Education

- Conflict Theory → Education system is unequal
 - Refers to unequal access, experience, and outcomes
- Feminist Theory → Gender based inequalities (especially focused on women), such as field of study choices and their impact on career
- Symbolic Interactionism → Classroom dynamics between student and teacher, especially those that shape outcomes
- Structural Functionalism → The functions of education, including skill-building, character-building, and sorting people into different occupational pathways
- Postmodernism → Education institutions as tools for surveillance and the regulation of students